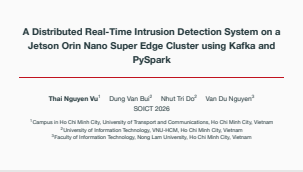
A Distributed Real-Time Intrusion Detection System on a Jetson Orin Nano Super Edge Cluster using Kafka and PySpark

Thai Nguyen Vu[1] Dung Van Bui[2] Nhut Tri Do[2] Van Du Nguyen[3]

SOICT 2026

[1]Campus in Ho Chi Minh City, University of Transport and Communications, Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam
[2]University of Information Technology, VNU-HCM, Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam
[3]Faculty of Information Technology, Nong Lam University, Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam



Good morning. I will show what a second edge board actually buys you when you split an ML intrusion detector across two Jetson Orin Nano Super devices. Seven minutes, four results.

I. PROBLEM AND CONTRIBUTIONS

Edge intrusion detection: three open gaps

Detectors now *fit* on single-board hardware — but a monolithic one classifies **every** flow and saturates an 8 GB ARM board.

What the literature does not tell us

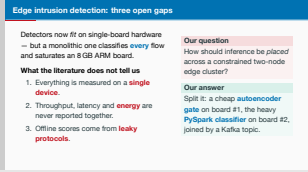
1. Everything is measured on a **single device**.
2. Throughput, latency and **energy** are never reported together.
3. Offline scores come from **leaky protocols**.

Our question

How should inference be *placed* across a constrained two-node edge cluster?

Our answer

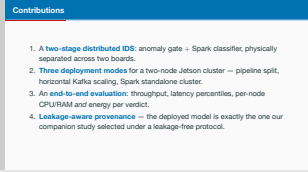
Split it: a cheap **autoencoder gate** on board #1, the heavy **PySpark classifier** on board #2, joined by a Kafka topic.



Three gaps: single-device evaluation, energy never reported next to latency, and offline numbers taken from leaky pipelines. Which model to deploy is the other half of the question. We attack all three with one system.

Contributions

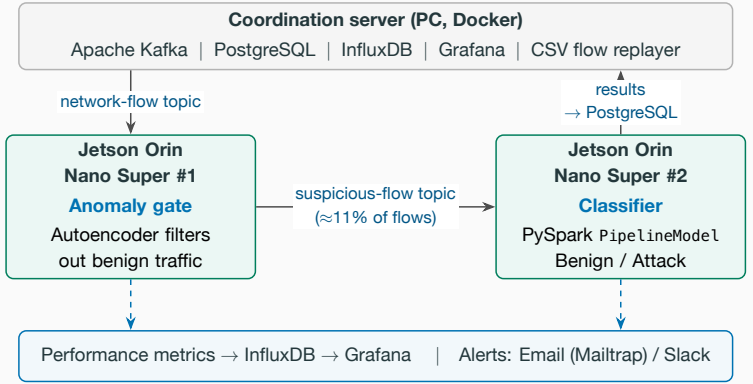
1. A **two-stage distributed IDS**: anomaly gate + Spark classifier, physically separated across two boards.
2. **Three deployment modes** for a two-node Jetson cluster — pipeline split, horizontal Kafka scaling, Spark standalone cluster.
3. An **end-to-end evaluation**: throughput, latency percentiles, per-node CPU/RAM *and* energy per verdict.
4. **Leakage-aware provenance** — the deployed model is exactly the one our companion study selected under a leakage-free protocol.



Four contributions. The fourth matters: the model we deploy is not a fresh model, it is the one that survived a strict offline audit.

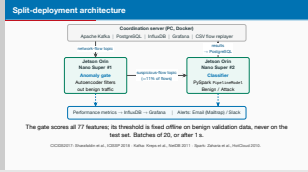
II. SYSTEM AND EVALUATION SETUP

Split-deployment architecture



The gate scores all 77 features; its threshold is fixed *offline* on benign validation data, never on the test set. Batches of 20, or after 1 s.

CICIDS2017: Sharafaldin et al., ICISSP 2018 · Kafka: Kreps et al., NetDB 2011 · Spark: Zaharia et al., HotCloud 2010.



Host runs the infrastructure. Board one gates, board two classifies. Only suspicious flows cross the Kafka topic between them. Everything is instrumented into Grafana.

Deployment modes and what we measure

Single node full pipeline on one board, gate off or on.

A: Pipeline split gate on #1, classifier on #2 (our design).

B: Horizontal both boards run the full role (gate off).

C: Spark cluster host as master, both boards as workers.

Every flow is followed from send to verdict, queueing included. **Sustained capacity**: the highest rate at which every flow gets its verdict within 10 s of the load.

Setup

2× Jetson Orin Nano Super
(6-core A78AE, 8 GB, ≈67 TOPS)

PySpark 3.4.1, Kafka 3.5, Wi-Fi LAN

10,000 test-split flows, 15% attacks

Rate sweep 1–40 flows/s, 2 runs each

Energy via `tegrastats`

Latency is measured from the moment a flow is sent to the moment its verdict is written, so time spent waiting in a queue counts. A fresh Kafka consumer group per run, so no run inherits another's backlog.

III. RESULTS AND CONCLUSION

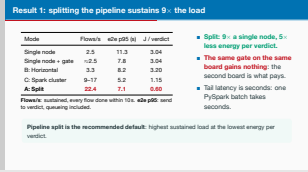
Result 1: splitting the pipeline sustains 9× the load

Mode	Flows/s	e2e p95 (s)	J / verdict
Single node	2.5	11.3	3.04
Single node + gate	≈2.5	7.8	3.04
B: Horizontal	3.3	8.2	3.20
C: Spark cluster	9–17	5.2	1.15
A: Split	**22.4**	**7.1**	**0.60**

Flows/s: sustained, every flow done within 10 s. **e2e p95**: send to verdict, queueing included.

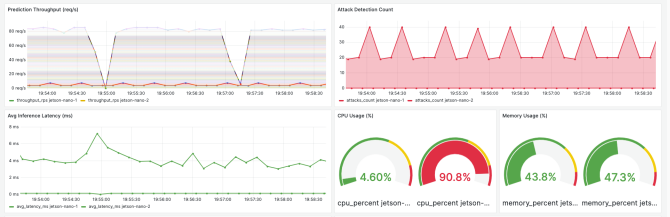
- **Split: 9× a single node, 5× less energy per verdict.**
- **The same gate on the same board gains nothing**: the second board is what pays.
- Tail latency is seconds: one PySpark batch takes seconds.

Pipeline split is the recommended default: highest sustained load at the lowest energy per verdict.



Single node and horizontal run with the gate off, as in the submitted version. Energy is measured at each mode's sustained rate: 2.0, 2.0, 3.9, 9.5 and 18.4 flows per second. Gate skip is about 89 percent in every gated mode. Median latency in split mode is about one second. Single node plus gate: the 10 second rule puts it at 1.9 only because one repeat drained in 10.6 seconds; at 3 flows per second it delivers 2.4 to 2.5 like the single node. Spark cluster: at 20 flows per second one repeat kept up at 17.1 and the other did not, so its capacity is only known to lie between about 9 and 17.

Result 2: the load asymmetry is visible live



At peak load, split mode (earlier run, previous model):

- gate node: **4.6% CPU**
- classifier node: **90.8% CPU**

The classifier dominates the compute budget — which is exactly why moving it off the ingest path pays.

Result 2: the load asymmetry is visible live
At peak load, split mode (earlier run, previous model):
gate node: 4.6% CPU
classifier node: 90.8% CPU
The classifier dominates the compute budget — which is exactly why moving it off the ingest path pays.

Live Grafana at peak load. Under five versus ninety-one percent. The asymmetry is the whole argument for the split. Add: the gate is a tunable filter, not a fixed point — backup slide has the operating curve.

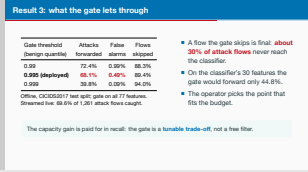
Result 3: what the gate lets through

Gate threshold (benign quantile)	Attacks forwarded	False alarms	Flows skipped
0.99	72.4%	0.99%	88.3%
0.995 (deployed)	**68.1%**	**0.49%**	89.4%
0.999	39.8%	0.09%	94.0%

Offline: CICIDS2017 test split; gate on all 77 features.
Streamed live: 69.6% of 1,261 attack flows caught.

- A flow the gate skips is final: **about 30% of attack flows** never reach the classifier.
- On the classifier's 30 features the gate would forward only 44.8%.
- The operator picks the point that fits the budget.

The capacity gain is paid for in recall: the gate is a **tunable trade-off**, not a free filter.



Numbers from results/ml_08_anomaly_gate/gate_operating_points.csv; the deployed threshold is quantile 0.995. Without the gate, every attack flow in the replay was caught, so the loss is the gate's.

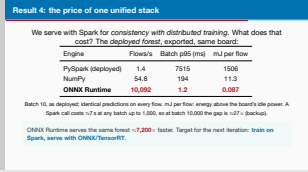
Result 4: the price of one unified stack

We serve with Spark for *consistency with distributed training*. What does that cost? The *deployed forest*, exported, same board:

Engine	Flows/s	Batch p95 (ms)	mJ per flow
PySpark (deployed)	1.4	7515	1506
NumPy	54.8	194	11.3
ONNX Runtime	**10,092**	**1.2**	**0.087**

Batch 10, as deployed; identical predictions on every flow. mJ per flow: energy above the board's idle power. A Spark call costs ≈7 s at any batch up to 1,000, so at batch 10,000 the gap is ≈27× (backup).

ONNX Runtime serves the same forest ≈**7,200**× faster. Target for the next iteration: **train on Spark, serve with ONNX/TensorRT**.



The JVM costs us more than three orders of magnitude, and that sets the roadmap. Batch size 10. If asked whether bigger batches fix it: a Spark call costs about seven seconds whatever the batch, so the gap shrinks to about 27 times at ten thousand flows, but a streaming IDS at 20 flows per second would wait eight minutes to fill such a batch.

Conclusion

What we showed

- A reproducible distributed edge IDS: Kafka + PySpark on a Jetson Orin Nano Super cluster.
- Gate and classifier on separate boards: **2.5 → 22.4 flows/s** sustained, e2e p95 ≈7 s.
- Energy per verdict: **3.0 J → 0.60 J**.
- ONNX serves the same forest ≈7,200× faster.

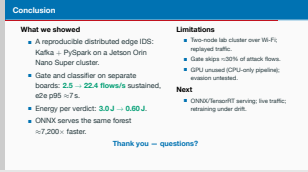
Limitations

- Two-node lab cluster over Wi-Fi; replayed traffic.
- Gate skips ≈30% of attack flows.
- GPU unused (CPU-only pipeline); evasion untested.

Next

- ONNX/TensorRT serving; live traffic; retraining under drift.

Thank you — questions?


Conclusion
What we showed
A reproducible distributed edge IDS: Kafka + PySpark on a Jetson Orin Nano Super cluster.
Gate and classifier on separate boards: 2.5 → 22.4 flows/s sustained, e2e p95 ≈7 s.
Energy per verdict: 3.0 J → 0.60 J.
ONNX serves the same forest ≈7,200× faster.
Limitations
Two-node lab cluster over Wi-Fi; replayed traffic.
Gate skips ≈30% of attack flows.
GPU unused (CPU-only pipeline); evasion untested.
Next
ONNX/TensorRT serving; live traffic; retraining under drift.
Thank you — questions?

Recap: nine times the load, five times less energy per verdict, and the price, about thirty percent of attacks skipped by the gate.

Key references

[1] Sharafaldin, I., Lashkari, A. H. & Ghorbani, A. A. *Toward generating a new intrusion detection dataset and intrusion traffic characterization*. ICISSP 2018. **CICIDS2017**

[2] Shi, W. et al. *Edge computing: Vision and challenges*. IEEE Internet of Things Journal 3(5), 2016. **edge setting**

[3] Chandola, V., Banerjee, A. & Kumar, V. *Anomaly detection: A survey*. ACM Computing Surveys 41(3), 2009. **anomaly gate**

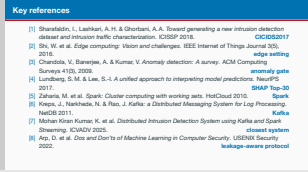
[4] Lundberg, S. M. & Lee, S.-I. *A unified approach to interpreting model predictions*. NeurIPS 2017. **SHAP Top-30**

[5] Zaharia, M. et al. *Spark: Cluster computing with working sets*. HotCloud 2010. **Spark**

[6] Kreps, J., Narkhede, N. & Rao, J. *Kafka: a Distributed Messaging System for Log Processing*. NetDB 2011. **Kafka**

[7] Mohan Kiran Kumar, K. et al. *Distributed Intrusion Detection System using Kafka and Spark Streaming*. ICVADV 2025. **closest system**

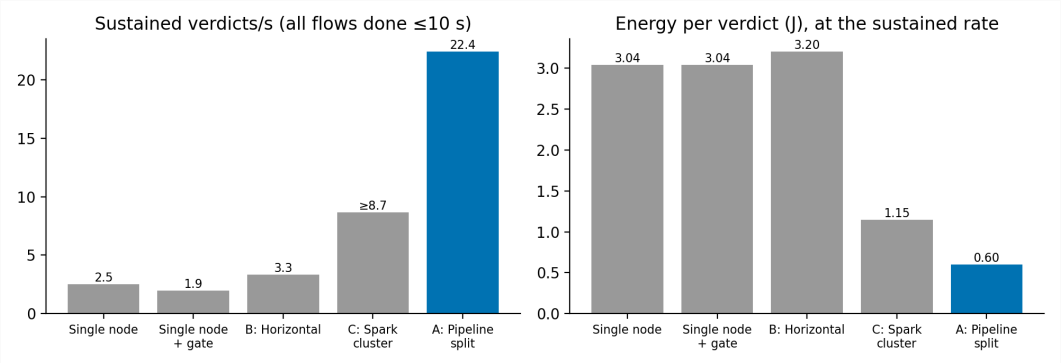
[8] Arp, D. et al. *Dos and Don'ts of Machine Learning in Computer Security*. USENIX Security 2022. **leakage-aware protocol**



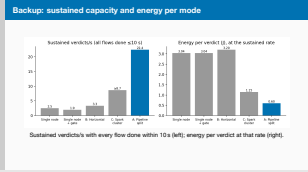
Not presented — shown while taking questions, so sources are on screen if the audience asks. Full list is in the paper.

Backup slides

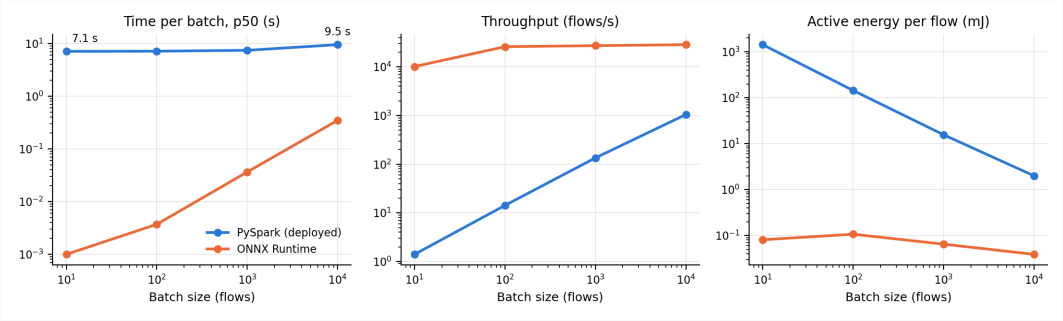
Backup: sustained capacity and energy per mode



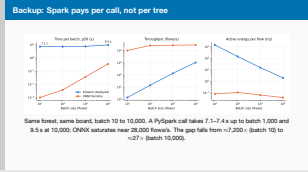
Sustained verdicts/s with every flow done within 10 s (left); energy per verdict at that rate (right).



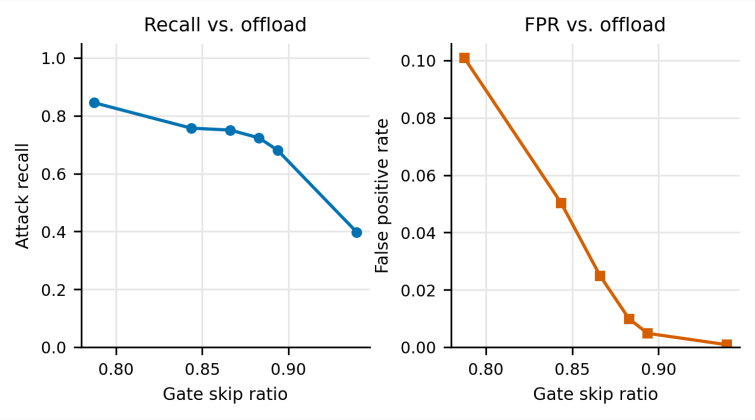
Backup: Spark pays per call, not per tree



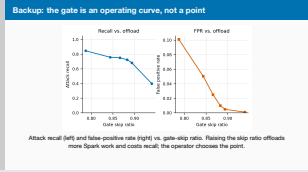
Same forest, same board, batch 10 to 10,000. A PySpark call takes 7.1–7.4 s up to batch 1,000 and 9.5 s at 10,000; ONNX saturates near 28,000 flows/s. The gap falls from ≈7,200× (batch 10) to ≈27× (batch 10,000).



Backup: the gate is an operating curve, not a point



Attack recall (left) and false-positive rate (right) vs. gate-skip ratio. Raising the skip ratio offloads more Spark work and costs recall; the operator chooses the point.



Backup: which model, and why

Configuration	F1	Features	Size (MB)	Edge rationale
Baseline + XGBoost	0.9971	77	2.32	Reference accuracy
SHAP Top-30 + XGBoost	0.9970	30	0.003[†]	Explainable; deployed feature set
RF Top-30 + XGBoost	0.9922	30	2.52	Embedded ranking
PCA k=40 + XGBoost	0.9939	40	3.82	Unsupervised reduction

We deploy **SHAP Top-30 with Random Forest** (exported model: test F1 0.9959, 30 features): a native Spark ML estimator, so the `PipelineModel` loads on ARM64 without the native libraries Spark's XGBoost integration needs. The SHAP ranking is computed after `destination_port` is removed.

[†] Distributed saving under-reports size; true size ≈2.5 MB.

Backup: which model, and why

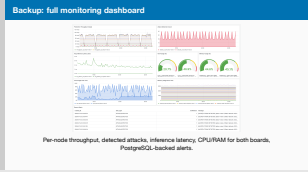
Configuration | F1 | Features | Size (MB) | Edge rationale
Baseline + XGBoost | 0.9971 | 77 | 2.32 | Reference accuracy
SHAP Top-30 + XGBoost | 0.9970 | 30 | 0.003† | Explainable; deployed feature set
RF Top-30 + XGBoost | 0.9922 | 30 | 2.52 | Embedded ranking
PCA k=40 + XGBoost | 0.9939 | 40 | 3.82 | Unsupervised reduction

We deploy SHAP Top-30 with Random Forest (exported model: test F1 0.9959, 30 features): a native Spark ML estimator, so the PipelineModel loads on ARM64 without the native libraries Spark's XGBoost integration needs. The SHAP ranking is computed after destination_port is removed.
† Distributed saving under-reports size; true size ≈2.5 MB.

Backup: full monitoring dashboard



Per-node throughput, detected attacks, inference latency, CPU/RAM for both boards, PostgreSQL-backed alerts.



Backup: measurement protocol

- Host-side orchestration starts pipeline roles on the Jetsons over SSH, drives the load, collects every verdict.
- Each verdict stores the flow's send time and replay row: latency is send to verdict, *queueing included*; skip ratio and attack recall come from the flows themselves.
- Rate sweep per mode; a rate is sustained when every flow sent in the 45 s window gets its verdict within 10 s after it. 2 runs per rate.
- Fresh Kafka consumer group per run, so no run inherits a backlog.
- Tiers batch 20 flows or flush after 1 s.
- Energy: `tegrastats`, 30 s idle baseline then load at the sustained rate; two-node modes sum both boards.

Backup: measurement protocol

- Host-side orchestration starts pipeline roles on the Jetsons over SSH, drives the load, collects every verdict.
- Each verdict stores the flow's send time and replay row: latency is send to verdict, *queueing included*; skip ratio and attack recall come from the flows themselves.
- Rate sweep per mode; a rate is sustained when every flow sent in the 45 s window gets its verdict within 10 s after it. 2 runs per rate.
- Fresh Kafka consumer group per run, so no run inherits a backlog.
- Tiers batch 20 flows or flush after 1 s.
- Energy: `tegrastats`, 30 s idle baseline then load at the sustained rate; two-node modes sum both boards.